

Commercial Forestry Practices

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Commercial Forestry Practices (A07692)

Short Title: Commercial Forestry Practices
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Forestry
Author ABOOTH
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module is designed for students to develop professional competence in the range of management services that foresters offer clients in Irish forestry. The module will be taught through a series of field-based projects in afforestation, young plantation management, forest valuation, harvest planning and forest roads.

Programmes

FORS-0014 BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)

3 / 6 / M

Indicative Content

- Afforestation development plan
- Management plan for young forest plantation
- Woodland improvement plan
- FEPS development/application plan
- Assessment of forest for FSC certification of sustainable forest management
- Felling licence application
- Forest road development
- Harvest planning
- Forest valuation

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Complete forest grant applications to forest service standards.
2. Appraise the requirements for afforestation site operations and quantify potential costs.
3. Maximise the commercial potential from grant aided forest projects and provide forest valuation based on net present value.
4. Classify and quantify environmental/biodiversity aspects in commercial forest projects and implement mitigation/statutory requirements within commercial forest projects.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Practicals: students will visit forest sites, carry out measurements and appropriate information gathering, record results on maps and field-sheets, draw conclusions and make recommendations.
- Tutorials: will be used to give support and feedback to students on their project portfolio.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	1,2,3,4
Portfolio	100%	1,2,3,4

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out assessments. Failure to meet the objectives of assessments. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research. Unable to present written work with attention to correct formatting, grammar and spelling.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Show some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on assessments. Attempt made to meet objectives and carry out independent study and research. Final result lacks balance and arguments undeveloped. Can present written work correctly formatted with minor grammar and spelling errors only.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carry out assessments. Satisfactory handling and awareness in carrying out independent study and research. Reporting and projects adequately structured and referenced.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style. Demonstrate initiative and the ability to criticise methods used and appreciation of experimental design and current knowledge limitations when carrying out assessments. Projects and reporting coherent and soundly structured illustrating wide and in depth reading on subject coupled with the proper use of references.
- 70%-100%:** All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Tutorial	24	
Field Trips	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Forest Service, Anon. _Code of Best Forest Practice_. Ireland: Department of Agriculture & Food, 2000.
- Forest Service, Anon. _Forest Service Guidelines on Archaeology, Water Quality, Biodiversity, Aerial Fertilisation, Harvesting and Forest Protection._. Ireland: Department of Agriculture & Food, 2000.
- Forest Service, Anon. _Forestry Schemes Procedures & Standards Manual_. Ireland: Department of Agriculture & Food, 2014.
- Forest Service, Anon. _Irish National Forest Standard_. Ireland: Department of Agriculture & Food, 2000.
- Ryan, et al. _Forest Road Manual_. Ireland: COFORD, 2004.